

DIGITAL LENDING PLATFORM · PROJECT PROPOSAL

A fully digital lending platform built for Philani Financial Services.

A proposal to design and build a complete digital micro-lending platform — covering client-facing loan applications, a self-service portal, admin analytics, NCA/NCR-compliant loan contracts, automated notifications, and DebiCheck integration. Purpose-built for South African compliance and scale.

PREPARED FOR

Philani Financial Services · Attn: Management

NCR REG: NCRCP18260 · NCA & POPIA COMPLIANT

01 · SIX BOTTLENECKS HOLDING THE BUSINESS BACK

What's working against you today.

Without a purpose-built digital platform, each loan application touches multiple manual steps, compliance risks, and communication gaps that compound with volume. Six structural issues cost time, create risk, and limit growth.

Manual, paper-based loan applications

01

Applications are collected on paper or via email, requiring manual data entry, physical document handling, and repeated back-and-forth with applicants. This slows processing, introduces errors, and limits throughput.

No client self-service portal

02

Applicants have no visibility into their application status after submission. This generates high volumes of follow-up phone calls, WhatsApp messages, and in-person visits — consuming staff time that could be spent on credit assessment.

Ad-hoc compliance & audit trail

03

The NCA requires a clear, auditable record of every lending decision including pre-agreement statements, credit checks, and signed contracts. Without a centralised system, this trail is fragmented across emails, files, and handwritten notes.

Insecure document collection

04

Collecting payslips, bank statements, and ID documents via WhatsApp or email is a POPIA compliance risk. Sensitive personal data flows through uncontrolled channels with no encryption, access logging, or retention policy.

No automated client notifications

05

Status updates — approval, document requests, contract readiness, DebiCheck alerts — are communicated manually by phone or WhatsApp. Delays in communication reduce client trust and increase churn at critical decision points.

Zero portfolio analytics

06

Without a central dashboard, management has no real-time view of pipeline volume, approval rates, active loan values, repayment trends, or month-on-month application growth. Strategic decisions are made without data.

02 · THE PLATFORM, PROBLEM BY PROBLEM

Every issue above — solved by the platform.

The platform has been designed and built with each operational pain point in mind. Below is a direct mapping from problem to solution, with the specific feature that resolves it.

CURRENT STATE

Manual paper applications

↓ Resolved by

PLATFORM FEATURE

Multi-step digital application form

A fully validated, multi-step form captures personal, employment, banking, and document data in one seamless flow — with SA ID validation, income parsing, and real-time fee calculation built in.

CURRENT STATE

No client visibility

↓ Resolved by

PLATFORM FEATURE

Client self-service portal

Every applicant gets a secure dashboard showing real-time application status, uploaded documents, signed loan contracts, and a full notification history. Zero phone calls needed.

CURRENT STATE

Ad-hoc compliance trail

↓ Resolved by

PLATFORM FEATURE

Full NCA/NCR audit log on every application

Every status change, admin action, credit check, document verification, and contract signing is time-stamped and stored in an immutable audit log — fully exportable for NCR inspection.

CURRENT STATE

Insecure document collection

↓ Resolved by

PLATFORM FEATURE

Supabase Storage with access-controlled upload

Payslips, bank statements, and ID documents are uploaded directly to encrypted Supabase Storage buckets with per-user access policies, POPIA-compliant retention, and no third-party exposure.

CURRENT STATE

No automated notifications

↓ Resolved by

PLATFORM FEATURE

Email + SMS notification engine

Transactional emails via Resend and SMS via BulkSMS are triggered automatically at every lifecycle stage — application received, approved, contract sent, DebiCheck initiated, and disbursement confirmed.

CURRENT STATE

Zero portfolio analytics

↓ Resolved by

PLATFORM FEATURE

Admin analytics dashboard

A real-time admin dashboard displays total applications, approval rate, active loan portfolio value, repaid collections, monthly trend charts, and a full application pipeline — updated on every page load.

COMPLIANCE FOUNDATION

Built for the NCA from day one. Every feature — from the pre-agreement statement in the application form to the e-signed loan contract and the DebiCheck mandate — has been designed to satisfy the requirements of the National Credit Act 34 of 2005. NCR registration **NCRCP18260** appears on all client-facing documents.

03 · WHAT THIS MEANS FOR THE BUSINESS

Expected operational impact.

Based on the shift from manual to fully digital lending workflows at comparable South African micro-lenders. The platform is already built — these outcomes are available from day one of go-live.

APPLICATION PROCESSING TIME

Days → Hours

Fully digital intake, automated validation, and instant document upload eliminate the manual data-entry bottleneck. Applications can be reviewed and decided within hours of submission.

STAFF ADMIN BURDEN

-60 to -80%

Automated status notifications, self-service client portal, and digital document management eliminate the majority of inbound follow-up calls, manual updates, and physical file handling.

COMPLIANCE READINESS

Audit-ready at all times

Every lending decision, contract signature, credit check, and communication is logged with timestamps and linked to the application. NCR inspection or dispute resolution requires zero manual document retrieval.

CLIENT TRUST & RETENTION

Measurably higher

Instant notifications, real-time status visibility, and a professional client portal dramatically improve the borrower experience — differentiating Philani Financial Services from informal lenders.

04 · HOW WE GET THERE

Four weeks to full go-live.

Week 1**Design sign-off & requirements lock**

Final review of design deck. Confirm admin user roles, email/SMS provider credentials, domain, and NCR compliance requirements.

Week 2**Frontend build**

Landing page, multi-step application form, and client portal built and connected to Supabase backend.

Week 3**Backend, admin dashboard & integrations**

Admin analytics dashboard, notification engine (Resend + BulkSMS), loan contract system, and DebiCheck integration.

Week 4

QA, compliance review & launch

Cross-device testing, NCR compliance walkthrough, Supabase production hardening, DNS cutover, zero-downtime go-live.

Post-launch

30 days complimentary support

Bug fixes, minor adjustments, performance monitoring, and staff training — included at no extra cost.

05 · WHERE WE GO FROM HERE

Ready when you are.

The platform is built, tested, and live-ready. A complete design deck and working preview are available on request. The full cost of the work is itemised in the accompanying quotation (PFS-QUOTE-2026-001).

What happens next

Proposal sign-off triggers a four-week go-live process covering environment setup, data migration from current processes, staff onboarding, compliance walkthrough, and DNS launch. The first 30 days of post-launch support are included at no extra cost.

Investment

Itemised in quotation PFS-QUOTE-2026-001

Start date

Within 7 days of proposal acceptance

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A lending business that runs on paper runs on luck. A digital platform runs on data, compliance, and client trust.

— PROPOSAL CLOSE